CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader with over 10 years of hands-on experience in software development and technical management, with a deep focus on high-load distributed systems, DevOps automation, and secure Linux environments. Proven track record in driving architectural strategy, mentoring engineering teams, and leading mission-critical initiatives in remote-first environments. Blends system-level technical depth with cross-functional leadership to deliver scalable, resilient software solutions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages**: Python, C++, Go, Bash, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL
- **Infrastructure**: Linux (system-level), Docker, Kubernetes, Ansible, Terraform, NGINX
- **DevOps**: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, AWS, GCP
- **Systems**: Distributed Systems, Network Protocols, Load Balancing, Caching (Redis, Memcached)
- **Databases**: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, SQLite
- **Tools**: Git, Jira, Confluence, Slack, VSCode, PyCharm, Vim
- **Security**: SSH, TLS, firewalls, intrusion detection, OWASP practices

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer
Sensidev
September 2021 – December 2024
Timişoara, Romania (Remote)

- Spearheaded architecture and backend systems for distributed microservices, focusing on scalability and availability using Kubernetes and Docker in a high-load production environment.
- Mentored and managed a globally distributed team of 10+ engineers, providing strategic direction and hands-on guidance across complex codebases and DevOps workflows.
- Championed Linux-first infrastructure, implementing system-level performance tuning and secure automation using shell scripts, Ansible, and systemd enhancements.
- Drove CI/CD improvements with GitLab pipelines and infrastructure-as-code (Terraform), reducing deployment time by 50% and incident rate by 40% within 6 months.
- Collaborated closely with product owners and security teams to translate roadmap features into resilient, testable solutions aligned with strict SLAs and compliance policies.
- Established code quality initiatives through peer reviews, automated linting, and team-wide refactoring sprints to maintain a sustainable, modular architecture.
- Led the implementation of internal observability stack (Prometheus, Grafana, ELK) improving incident response time by 70% and enabling proactive system health alerts.

- Acted as a player-coach in major crisis recoveries, directly debugging kernel-level issues in containerized environments and mentoring junior staff on root cause analysis.

Software Engineer
Syscom Digital
October 2019 – August 2021
Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Designed and implemented RESTful APIs and backend infrastructure for high-throughput marketing platforms serving real-time analytics across distributed nodes.
- Automated server configuration, deployment, and monitoring pipelines via Ansible and Jenkins, resulting in a 65% reduction in manual operational overhead.
- Implemented Python-based system daemons and CLI tools to streamline internal development workflows and real-time logging with advanced error tracking.
- Optimized query performance on PostgreSQL and MongoDB clusters using indexing strategies, resulting in 4x speed improvements for analytics dashboards.
- Collaborated with front-end teams to design API contracts and deliver fully documented services using OpenAPI and automated Swagger generation.
- Hardened infrastructure security by implementing system auditing, fail2ban, iptables rulesets, and automated patching mechanisms in Ubuntu and CentOS environments.
- Integrated monitoring and alerting solutions, drastically improving MTTR (mean time to recovery) through custom-built notification services and logging agents.
- Conducted quarterly internal technical audits, identifying architectural bottlenecks and initiating redesigns for improved service isolation and fault tolerance.

Software Developer
Soft Build
June 2016 – July 2019
Timişoara, Romania (Remote)

- Built full-stack applications with Python/Django and React, maintaining scalable codebases in Git-driven agile environments.
- Developed background workers for asynchronous task processing using Celery and RabbitMQ, managing job queues under heavy loads with real-time dashboards.
- Delivered containerized deployment pipelines using Docker Compose and Shell scripts for local development environments and production clusters.
- Maintained Linux servers for staging and production environments, performing regular system updates, backups, and Nginx configuration tuning.
- Created shell automation tools for engineers to bootstrap new services, significantly reducing setup time and increasing team autonomy.
- Led performance optimizations, including N+1 query fixes and static asset management, to meet aggressive page load targets on user-facing portals.
- Implemented role-based access control (RBAC) mechanisms across internal tools with JWT authentication and secure session handling.
- Partnered with QA teams to establish CI-integrated testing suites using Pytest and Selenium, increasing code coverage by over 30%.

Software Developer
Decima Digital
November 2015 – April 2016
Tallinn, Estonia

- Supported development of real-time content management tools for e-commerce platforms using Django, PostgreSQL, and Celery.
- Customized Linux virtual machines and deployment scripts to support seamless multi-environment development across engineering teams.
- Integrated third-party services via REST APIs and built asynchronous job execution systems using Redis and cron.
- Introduced automated tests and data validation procedures, improving system stability during integration cycles.
- Participated in architectural planning meetings, providing key input on modularity, database schema improvements, and endpoint versioning.
- Delivered bug fixes and enhancements within SLA timelines across multiple production environments using Git workflows.
- Created and maintained documentation for system modules, including internal CLI tools, endpoints, and deployment instructions.
- Actively collaborated with stakeholders and external vendors for API onboarding, system debugging, and data transformation tasks.

Software Developer Intern
Borna Technology
September 2014 – August 2015
Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Developed internal reporting and analytics dashboards with Python/Flask and PostgreSQL, improving reporting frequency and accuracy.
- Maintained and refactored legacy PHP scripts and shell-based utilities, migrating core logic to Python for maintainability.
- Gained deep exposure to Linux internals including process management, log rotation, cron jobs, and permission systems.
- Built internal CLI tools for system monitoring and log parsing used by sysadmins to diagnose failures and generate alerts.
- Assisted with development and testing of in-house security tools, contributing scripts for packet inspection and basic intrusion detection.
- Participated in code reviews and daily standups, gaining experience in agile software development workflows.
- Documented system configurations and deployment processes for future onboarding and system expansion.
- Supported DevOps team in setting up version control pipelines and managing backup/restore processes.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Linux Foundation Certified System Administrator (LFCS)**
- **AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional**
- **HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate**
- **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)**
- **Python for Systems Programming – edX**

PROJECTS

- ✓ **Distributed Config Management Tool**
  Architected a Python-based distributed configuration management system supporting dynamic reloads, change auditing, and secure credential rotation for Linux services.
- ✓ **High Availability Gateway Router**
  Led the development of a HA network routing gateway with Python, iptables, and systemd for a hosting provider, enabling zero-downtime maintenance and active failover.
- ✓ **CI/CD Self-Hosted Pipeline Framework**
  Built a modular GitLab-based pipeline framework automating build, test, and deploy stages with native container runners, SAST tools, and auto-rollbacks.